Open Channel Open Channel

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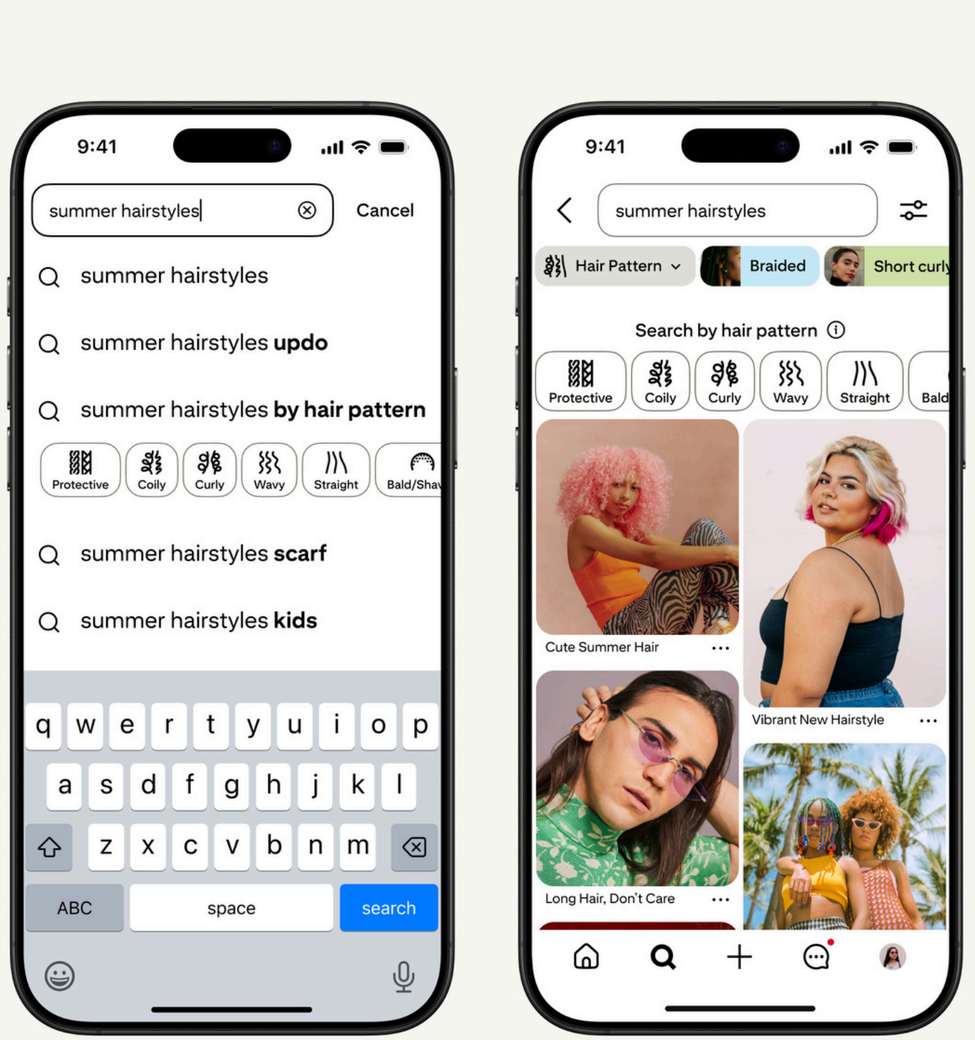
Pinterest's Problem Definition + Research



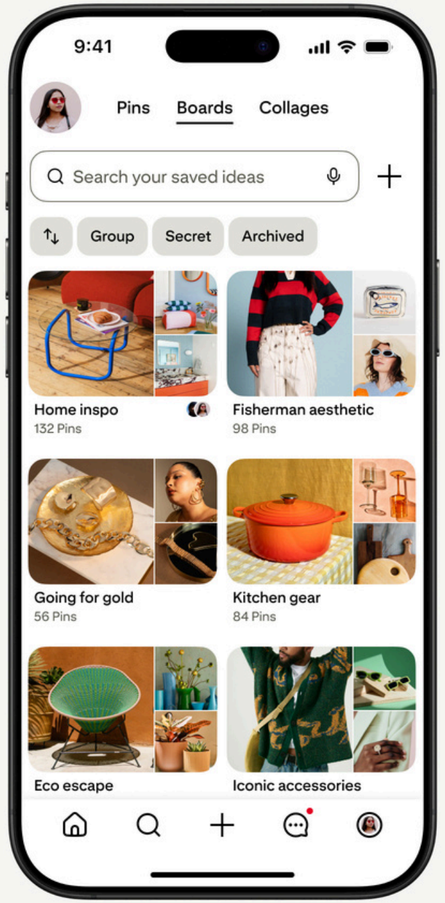
Pinterest has maintained its original concept: simplicity, low stress, and a safe space for creative organization. The platform creates a private space in which users organize their creative ideas (e.g., household decor, crafts, and fashion outfits). To curate a page that is cohesive with users' interests, Pinterest's algorithm curates a user's homepage based on past searches, clicks, and pins (saved content).

Pinterest is used as a visual search engine for home decor, fashion inspiration, crafting ideas, and so much more. People appreciate an app that is laid out according to their interests.

Pinterest has long functioned as a private tool for saving ideas; users do not expect conversation, connection, or collaboration. Users are inspired but isolated.

Pinterest users currently lack a prominent feature that would enable them to interact with other users in a collaborative environment. While some users enjoy that Pinterest is more about ideas and less about interaction, there is very little social connection. This leads to less variety and diversity.

Users want the opportunity to collaborate and connect, while also being able to have a space on the platform that can be kept to themselves. Without change, Pinterest risks narrowing the creative voices that make it so unique. Users will be limited in exposure to diverse creative approaches and lose the opportunity for innovation and discovery.

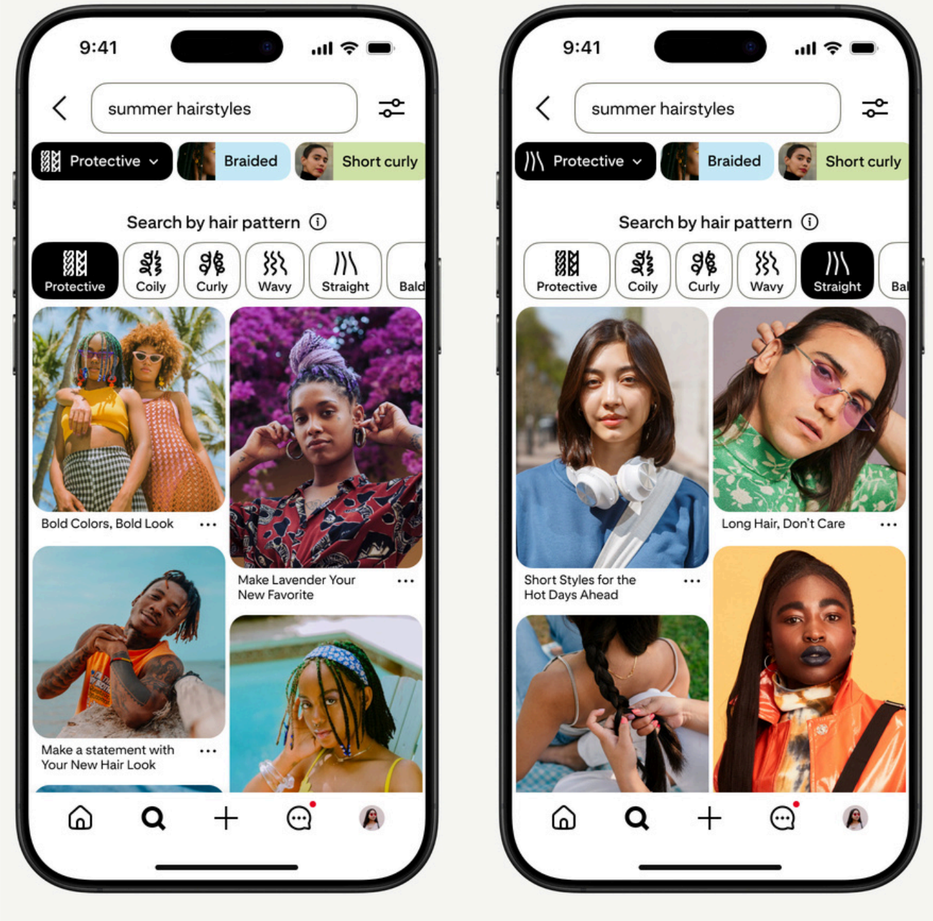


Pinterest's Insights + Cultural Connections

Globally, Pinterest is the 15th most used social media platform. Its users do not just scroll; they use the platform with an intent (e.g., shopping for clothes, finding inspiration, downloading images).

Right now, Pinterest is a trusted platform of passive inspiration that lacks interconnection. The challenge is to take Pinterest from a platform used as a solitary tool into a platform that fosters belonging and community, where people do not just save ideas but connect with others through them.

Life at Pinterest



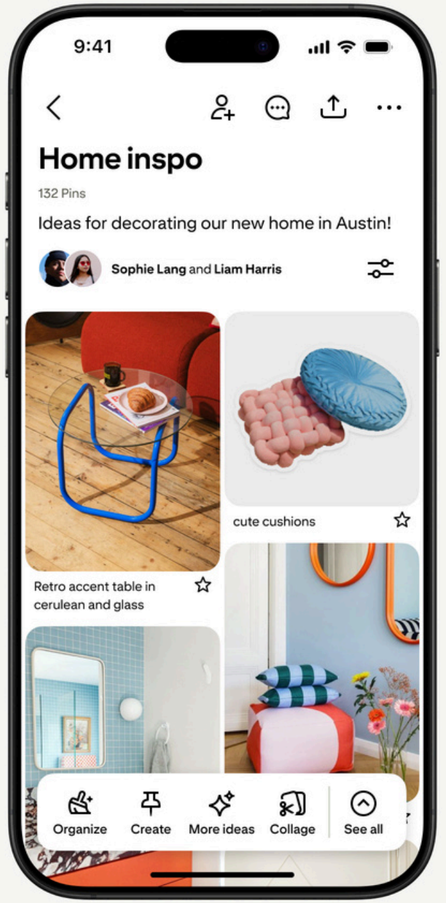
Pinterest's Audience

With over half a billion monthly active users, 90 million of those users are based in the United States. 26 million users are Gen Z, and nearly 70% of all users are women, with a large majority of those women between the ages of 18 and 34.

Pinterest is widely accessed by high-earning individuals/households; 1 in 3 Pinterest users has an income of over $100,000, and the platform reaches 40% of US households with an annual income over $150,000.

Based on this research, we chose to hone in on the most active users of Pinterest's current audience. We will aim to target women aged 18-34 as our audience for the platform's expansion.

Pinterest Demographics: Find Your Audience



Pinterest's Strategy + Rationale

Get: Pinterest's existing audience, primarily women aged 18-34, who currently use the platform to search for basic inspiration, to share ideas, and have open dialogue about shared interests, aesthetics, and goals

To: Recognize that having a space to build this sense of community in an already beloved app can both aid in expanding their goals and inspirations, while also fostering a sense of genuine connection and community among peers

By: Making Pinterest more than an app that simply promotes individual inspiration. A strong community group feature will allow the target audience to appreciate what they already love about the platform, while also expanding their connections and inspiration.

How, Where, & Why It Works

How: Pinterest is used to visually discover and inspire users through shared ideas that can be saved to their personal boards. Users can search for images using descriptions and keywords. Images that come up will be aligned to your algorithm, past clicks, saves, and boards. With Pinterest's new niche community groups feature, users can join niche spaces where their shared interests are shared, built upon, and inspire others.

Where: Pinterest can be used for all aspects of creativity and organization. From planning home decor, fashion choices, travel dreams, to recipes, the app is made to bring the user's vision to life. Community groups provide designated spaces in which users can show their projects (e.g., collages for magazines, home decor, and Instagram templates).

Why: Pinterest works because it can be used in whatever way best benefits the customer. Users actively find images for their organized boards, helping them build upon their creative accomplishments. Users utilize the app with the intention of buying, making, and planning a final product. Community groups strengthen this aspect of Pinterest by offering a space in which users can provide more personalized support and inspiration for specific interests.

Out of Home: Billboard

"Feeling Overwhelmed'' speaks on how often people feel lost when trying to find where they belong online or what communities fit their interests. The collage of different aesthetics represents the different niches people can explore. The message "Find Your Niche" encourages users to use Pinterest not just for inspiration but also to use it as a community-based platform where people can connect with others based on their interests.

Mock-Up #1: Vintage Clothing Store

Located outside of vintage stores across the country. Its relatively generic style makes it compatible with all types of second-hand clothes retailers.

Out of Home: Flyers

Pinterest enables users to find digital inspiration for their real lives. With that in mind, we wanted to promote this new feature in ways that felt authentic to users' lived experiences. These flyers would be placed in popular community gathering spots and would respond to the aesthetics of the surroundings.

They act as a play on traditional print advertisements and community group flyers stapled to telephone poles or put up in other public spaces. (That has had a resurgence as physical media becomes more popular among younger generations: See here!)

By seeing these subtle advertisements in places they already love and frequent, viewers feel a sense of connection, belonging, and authenticity from the start.

Mock-Up #2: Record Stores

Located outside of record stores across the country. People in search of vinyl are expanding on a hobby of listening to analog music, and are already in community spaces to expand their collection.

Mock-Up #3: Concert Go-ers

Located outside of concert venues, festivals, and public transportation to venues on concert days. Live music lovers are already inclined to find community in live shows, why not on Pinterest?

Mock-Up #4: Coffee Shops

Located outside of coffee shops. Local coffee shops are popular third spaces in small towns and big cities. People frequent them for convenience and community, both of which translate to Pinterest's new feature.

Video Concept 1: Find Yourself

Opening Scene:

Visual- A kid sits on the floor surrounded by scissors, glue, and scissors. They have carefully cut out pictures and glued them on a poster to make a collage. On the collage, there will be princess dresses, brand posters, soccer balls, and random colors.

Narration- “When we’re young, we want to try a little bit of everything.”

Scene #2

Visual- The same person growing up, but in different places.

- Trying on jewelry
- Looking at vintage clothing
- Trying on different sunglasses
- Taking selfies with their phone camera

Narration- “Some things stick, and some things don’t.”

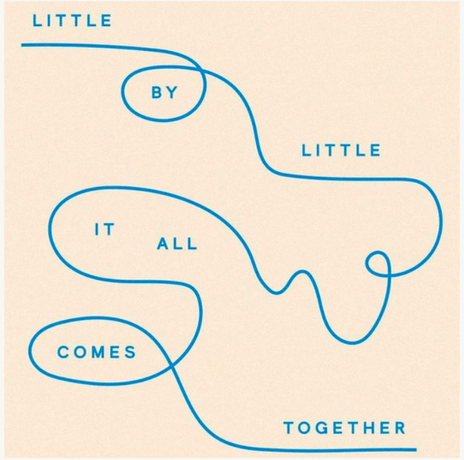
Scene #3

Visual- The child is now noticeably older, and you can see from their surroundings that they have different aesthetics. The screen flashes with flashbacks of their life and interest in photo memories and text.

Text reads-

- Princess
- Emo
- Skater
- Vintage
- Minimalistic
-

Narration- “Style changes. Interests evolve.”

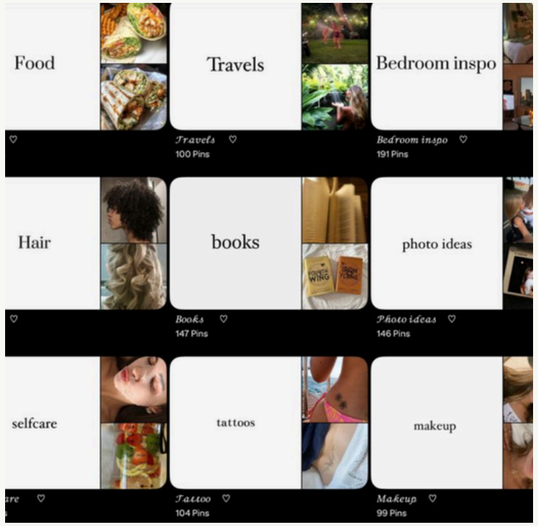


Scene #4

Visual- Now the person is an adult and opens their phone to Pinterest. We see them scrolling through their past Pinterest boards.

- Outfit Inspo
- Jewelry Wants
- DIY Art
- Flea Market Finds
- Art Direction

Narration- “But finding the things that inspire you never stops.”



Scene #5

Visual- The adult is going through their old things, and finds their old paper collages from when they were younger. They are looking at their current Pinterest boards while comparing them to the old paper collage. They are pointing and reacting to the matching ideas and aesthetics they both share.

Narration- “Your style has always been there, you just have to embrace it.”

Final Scene:

Visual- Split the screen to reveal the words “Find Your Niche” in colorful letters on a black screen. The Pinterest logo appears.

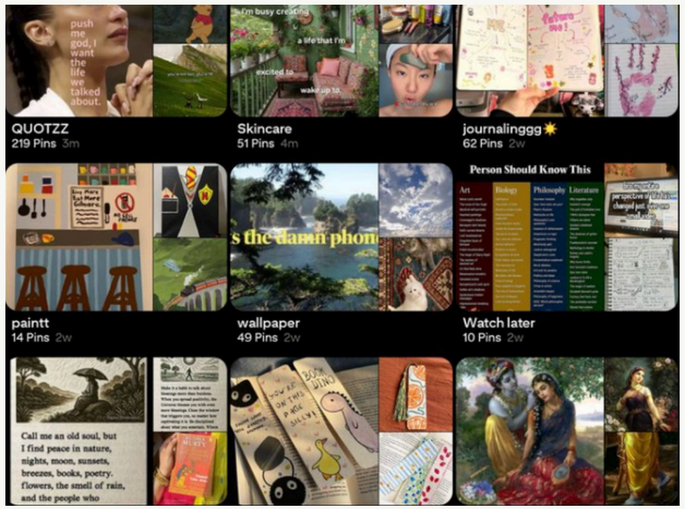
Video 2: Find Your People

Opening Scene

Visual: Subject alone and scrolling on their phone in their bed
Close up: Pinterest's boards are labeled with different things they are interested in

- Country style
- Cooking inspo
- Book club

Narration: “Sometimes you are just looking for inspiration.”



Scene #2

Visual: The subject starts saving pins to the board called “My Style.” The pins include outfits, music, jewelry, and thrifting finds. We see the subject go through the process of saving the image, creating a new board, and following community boards.

Narration: “But sometimes... You find a little something more.”

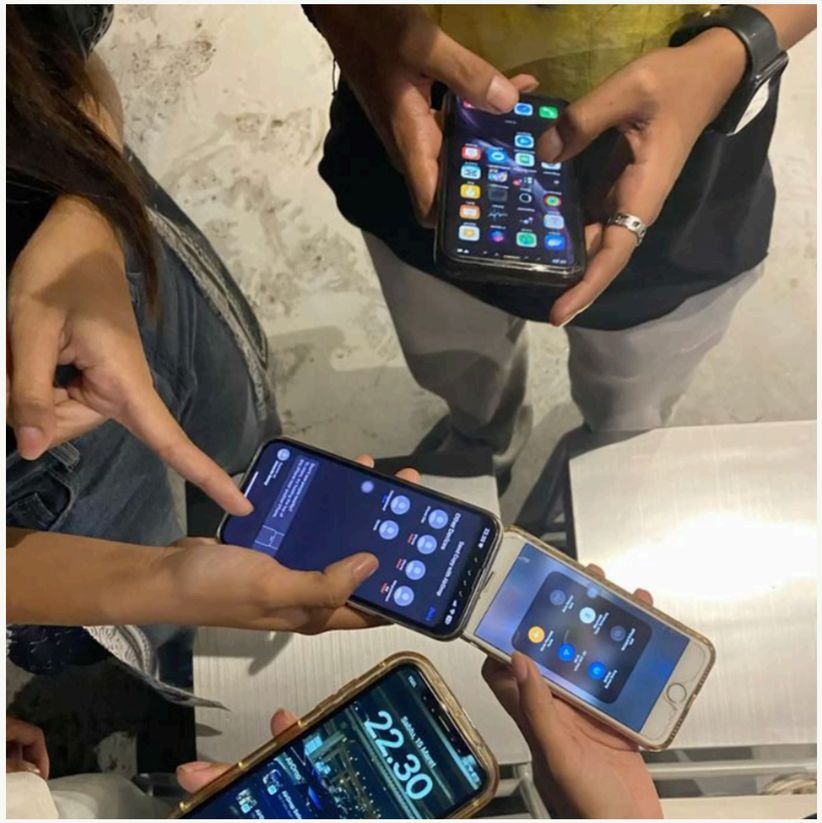
Scene #3

Visual: The saved pins seen at the bottom of the screen transition into real life. The person is thrifting vintage clothes, sewing patches on a top, and looking through old book stores.

Audio: Music playing in the background

Scene #4

Visual: At a small outside music venue, surrounded by people who are all similarly dressed. Someone says, “I love your top!” They started talking and bonding over their interests. This cuts to these people showing each other their Pinterest boards on their phones and becoming friends.



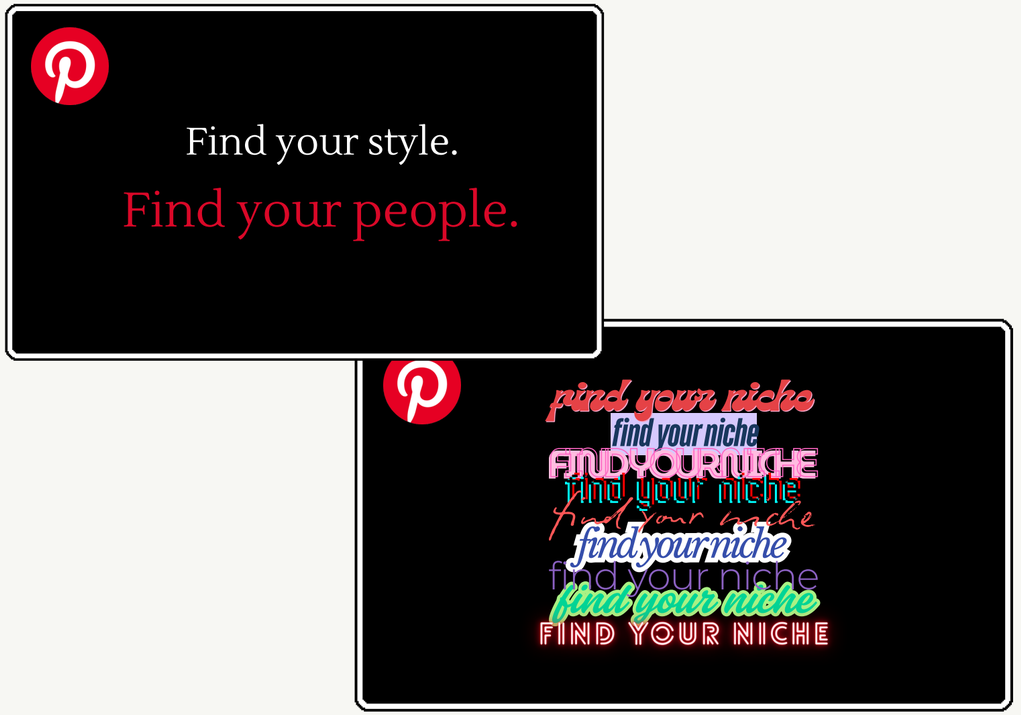
Scene #5

Visual: Now, a small group gets together to thrift, get coffee, and go to concerts.

Narration: “What starts as inspiration... can turn into connection.”

Final Scene:

Visual: Phone screen showing the Pinterest app and the board they started. Text on screen says “Pinterest – Find your style. Find your people.” End cut to black screen that says “Find Your Niche.”



Print 1: Magazine Spread

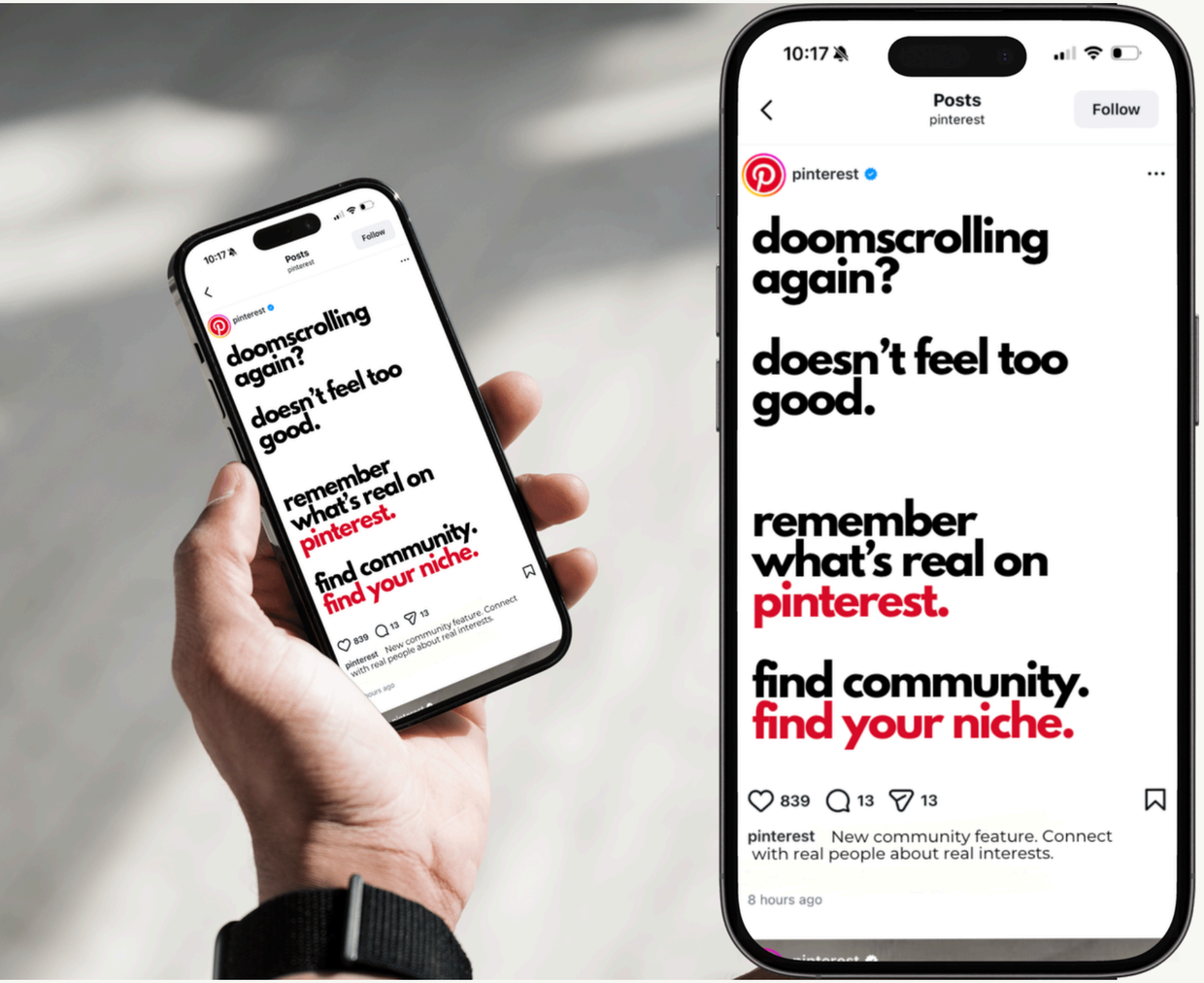
This is a mockup for a limited edition magazine spread from the “Find Your Niche” campaign. The magazine will contain various niches like the mockup spread below. These can be sold at stores and ordered online.

Each niche spread will have a QR code to Pinterest’s newest feature, allowing users to join that niche-specific online community group.

Print 2: Postcard

Physical postcards with the “Find Your Niche” slogan and/or aesthetics with varying interests will be mailed out with codes and links inviting recipients to join Pinterest’s online communities in which they can explore new niches. Using the postcards as entry points to niche-specific boards, Pinterest’s postcards are a connection between the online world and real life. What can start as a physical invitation to join a community of people who share that niche. This ad quite literally bridges the gap between the physical and the online.

Social Media 1 - Pinterest Is Real



As much of the campaign is focused on physical executions, we wanted to keep our social media campaigns simple. We didn't want to create an over-the-top social media frenzy, because Pinterest is often viewed as an escape from that feeling.

The blunt copy in this ad is a manifestation of the simple, stress-fee "non-social media" vibe of Pinterest. This ad would run across other social media platforms like Instagram, as pictured in the mockup. If users are mindlessly scrolling, it acts as a check point which allows them to snap out of their haze.

It is simple, yet effective in getting users to recognize the unhealthy behaviors other apps encourage while setting Pinterest as the exception. Instead of getting lost in the "fluff" of other social media, users can find something real on Pinterest.

Social Media 2 - #FindYourNiche

Pinterest will launch #FindYourNiche across various social media platforms. The post will show various activities, hobbies, or artworks that illustrate the wide variety of styles and interests that Pinterest contains for its users. In front of the image, will be the #FindYourNiche.

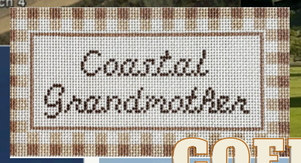
Using the hashtag, social media users can post about their own niches and interests on various platforms, helping Pinterest to promote its community group feature. This has the added benefit of making Pinterest feel like a real, interactive community rather than a bulletin of ideas.

Wildcard Execution: Niche Market

A pop-up market will give Pinterest users the opportunity to experience its new community feature firsthand.

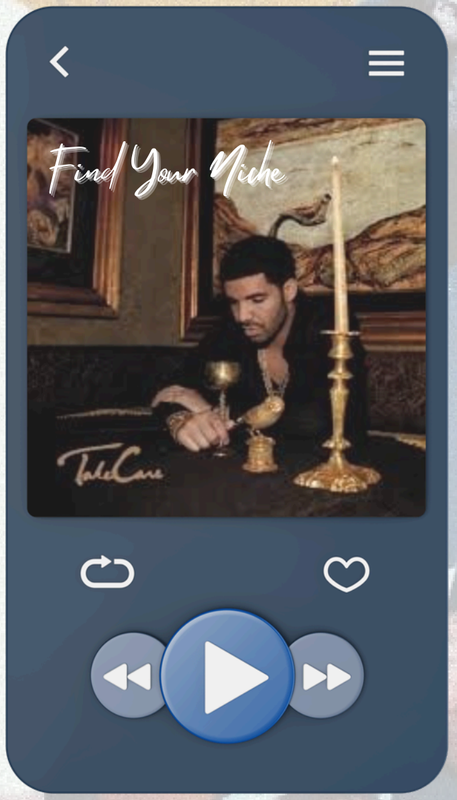
- Located in San Francisco's Golden Gate Park, the wide-open grassy fields with a history of artistic expression will be the perfect gathering place for creatives.
- Local vendors will set up shop within the park, each choosing different "niches" to be part of.
- Visually compelling signs will label each "niche" and direct shoppers through the market, allowing them to hop between "niches" to find what resonates with them.
- They will experience the benefits of community firsthand by interacting with vendors and fellow shoppers.
- Looking for cottage-style home goods? Trying to incorporate more vintage in your life? What about finding people who love concert posters just as much as you do? Pinterest's pop-up market will demonstrate how connecting through shared interests online has real-world benefits for users.

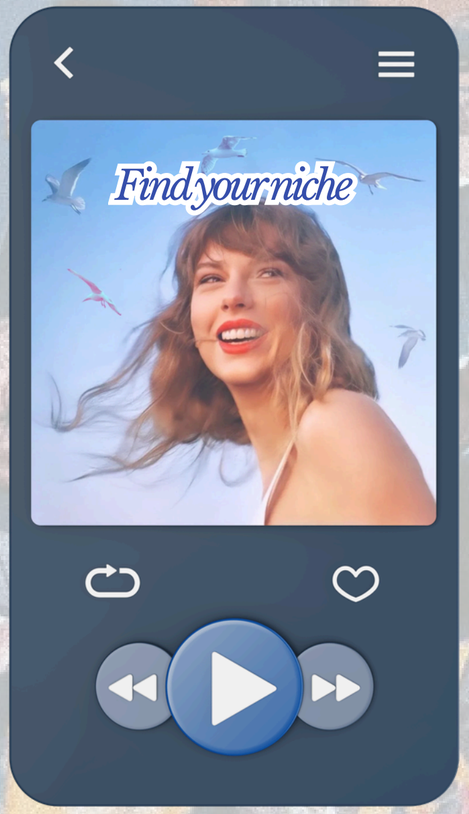
Market go-ers will be given a map of the field showing where each niche is located so they can explore with purpose.



Outside Lands is a music festival that takes place in Golden Gate Park that successfully creates shopping experiences for festival go-ers. While this is just a side feature of the festival, it is an excellent reference point for how a full market for Pinterest may look and operate in the park.

To the left a local vintage store, Moody Goose Vintage, share their experience as a vendor at OSL. This is an example of what the "Vintage Lovers" Niche could look like!





Wildcard Execution: Spotify Collab

Music is one of the many outlets people use to find their niche. Many people use music to align their aesthetic with their lifestyle, outfits, and overall identity. Pinterest is also one of the outlets people use to find their aesthetic. We thought, “Why not combine the two?” We plan to use music as a gateway for people to discover communities, encouraging further exploration and discovery of additional communities. The goal is to demonstrate how the platform’s authentic human creativity extends beyond visuals into everyday experiences such as music.

Ways to Evaluate Success

Our team's goal is to illustrate how Pinterest is not only a source of inspiration and online artistry but also a place where users can find creativity and support that translates into the real world. Community groups in which users can post to an ongoing thread help users feel that they have a consistent source of inspiration and support from a community that values their shared interests.

Pinterest will begin by launching its newest community groups feature by inviting select users to become creators for niche-specific interests. As the "Find Your Niche" ad campaign rolls out, Pinterest can measure the success of this feature by tracking the number of users who join established groups. As users start to create their own niche community groups, Pinterest can see how online traction develops. Pinterest can track the average number of posts submitted daily, how many users check in on their groups weekly, and the number of reactions (comments and likes - no reshares as posts remain inside of their respective community groups to preserve the niche environment) received.

Our team expects an increase in user communication and interaction as users begin to play around with the community groups feature.

Credit

Ucoby Hardy
- Strategy + Rationale Slide
- Out-of-Home Execution – Billboard
- Wild Card Execution – Album Covers

Malia Kappelman
- How, Where, and Why It Works
- Video Concepts (2) - Scripts + Images
- editing written work

Diana Morimoto
- Title Slide
  - “Find Your Niche” text graphic
- Table of Contents
- Problem Definition + Research
- Audience
- Insights + Cultural Connections
- Team Page
- Print Execution (2) - Magazine Spread + Postcard
- Social Media 2 - #FindYourNiche
- Ways to Evaluate Success
- slide deck styling and layout
- editing written work

Harmony Solis
- Found graphics for the inside of the magazine spread
- Found graphics for Out-of-Home Flyers

Kate Wiser
- Out of Home - Flyers (Copy, Design of Copy on Flyers, Written Explanations)
- Social Media - Pinterest Is Real
- Wildcard Execution - Flea Market

Sources

Research Links

- Pinterest Audience - Pinterest Demographics: Find Your Audience
- Insights + Cultural Connections - Life at Pinterest

Images

- “Find Your Niche” text designs based on design fonts from Canva
  - (including all mockups with “Find Your Niche” text)
- Video Mockup
  - All Images Sourced from Pinterest
- Wildcard Execution - Flea Market
  - Outside Lands Market Image
  - Polo Field Section Image
- Flyers, Magazine Spread
  - All Images Sourced from Pinterest

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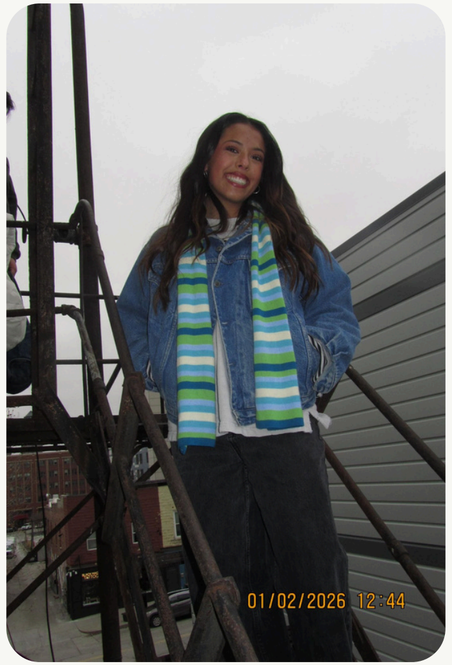

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